

Operational Escalation Policy

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Purpose

This policy defines the organisational approach to operational escalation when service pressure exceeds normal operating capacity.

Escalation triggers may include sustained bed occupancy pressure, emergency department crowding, ambulance handover delay, workforce shortages, increased incident activity, infection pressures and disruption to patient flow.

Operational leaders should review current pressure, confirm the severity of the situation, identify affected services and coordinate proportionate escalation actions.

Actions may include increasing management oversight, reviewing available capacity, redeploying resources, accelerating discharge processes, coordinating with site-flow teams and escalating unresolved risks through the agreed operational command structure.

Decisions should be documented, reviewed regularly and based on current approved operational information.

This document is intended for operational decision support and does not replace clinical judgement.